

Bar X Ranch — 4-Lot Feasibility Portfolio

Land acquisition · 5-bedroom build · private-lake access · Zone AE flood exposure — Angleton (unincorporated Brazoria County), TX 77515

Version: 2.0 (rebuild) **Prepared:** 10 Sep 2026 **Supersedes:** v1 generated portfolio (9 pp.)

Basis: primary regulation + public records **Full audit:** docs/AUDIT.md **Sources:** docs/SOURCES.md

READ THIS FIRST — STATUS OF THIS DOCUMENT

This is a **corrected rebuild** of an earlier generated portfolio. It fixes material errors in that document (septic sizing, permit fees, flood interpretation, and cost totals) and adds costs the original omitted entirely (windstorm insurance, property tax, POA carry, and the house itself). **It remains a desktop screening study.** No lot has been surveyed, no soil tested, and no BFE confirmed in writing. Every figure marked **UNVERIFIED** or **ESTIMATE** must be confirmed before it is relied on for a purchase decision. See the disclaimer in the footer.

VERIFIED traced to a primary/official source

UNVERIFIED from listing copy or the original doc; not confirmed

ESTIMATE planning figure, ranged

CONTENTS

1. Verdict & the open premise
2. Portfolio snapshot
3. The four lots
4. Flood: what we actually know
5. Buildability — 5BR + garage
6. Septic (OSSF) — corrected
7. Cost to build — corrected
8. Annual carrying cost
9. Insurance: flood + windstorm
10. Fishing & amenities
11. What changed from v1
12. Due-diligence sequence

1 · Verdict, and the question that must be answered first

The four lots are **likely buildable for a 5-bedroom home**, and their natural elevation (reported 28–30 ft, above the estimated ~24 ft base flood elevation) is a genuine advantage. But "buildable" is not the same as "advisable," and the earlier document reached a favourable conclusion by understating cost 3–6× and omitting whole categories of expense. Corrected, the picture is:

- **Land is the small number.** The all-in cost of putting a family into a house here is **~\$490k–\$890k on one lot**, of which land (\$45k–\$82.5k) is under 15%.

- **Flood exposure is real and permanent.** These are Zone AE parcels behind a non-accredited levee. Elevation helps; it does not remove the mapping, the insurance question, or the county's 2-ft freeboard rule.
- **The binding constraints are soil and utilities,** not the flood zone — soil class decides the septic system (\$8k vs \$25k), and distance to power decides the service-extension cost (\$0 vs \$25k).

THE UNRESOLVED PREMISE

The headline is “**\$234,500 · 4 lots,**” but every comparison is written to help pick *one* lot to build on. **These are different decisions.** Buying one lot to build needs a ranked recommendation; buying four as an investment needs a carrying-cost and resale thesis. Until you decide which, no total can be sized. This document provides the inputs for *both* but recommends resolving the premise before spending on survey or soil work.

2 • Portfolio snapshot

LAND, ALL 4 LOTS \$234,500 ~4.95 ac ACREAGE UNVERIFIED	ALL-IN, ONE LOT BUILT ~\$490k–890k land + site + 5BR house EST.	ANNUAL CARRY, 4 VACANT LOTS ~\$5.1–5.8k tax + POA + mowing RATES VERIFIED	INSURANCE ONCE BUILT ~\$5–9.5k/yr flood + windstorm + HO EST.
---	--	---	--

SITE FACTS THAT HOLD FOR ALL FOUR LOTS

FEMA FIRM Panel **48039C0605K**, effective **30 Dec 2020** **VERIFIED** · mapped **Zone AE** (1% annual-chance) behind the non-accredited Angleton Levee · Brazoria County requires finished floor **≥ 24 in above BFE** (freeboard set by Commissioners Court in **May 2005**) **VERIFIED** · water & sewer are **private well + on-site septic** (no municipal service) · school district is **Columbia-Brazoria ISD** **VERIFIED** .

3 • The four lots

Per-acre pricing below is computed **on each lot's stated acreage on a single consistent basis** — unlike v1, which priced one lot on a different (larger) acreage and so mis-ranked it. Flood data is shown once, at portfolio level, rather than copy-pasted per lot, because a single generic BFE was never lot-specific.

Price normalised to stated acreage. Lowest \$/acre in bold.

LOT	SECTION / ID	PRICE	STATED SIZE	\$/ACRE (STATED)	WATER
1127 Saddle Horn Bend	Bar X Ranch Sec 2	\$82,500	1.95 ac	\$42,308	Waterfront U
336 Wagon Wheel Trl W	Bar X Ranch (Lot 167) SEC?	\$45,000	1.00 ac	\$45,000	Waterfront U
Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trl	Bar X Ranch Sec 16	\$49,000	~1.0 ac EST	~\$49,000	Interior U
750 Wagon Wheel Trl	Bar X Ranch SEC?	\$58,000	1.0 ac /1.27?	\$58,000	Waterfront? CONFLICT

TWO FACTS TO RESOLVE BY PLAT BEFORE RANKING

(1) **750 Wagon Wheel Trl.** v1 classed it interior/road-frontage, but the listing of record markets it as a **cleared waterfront lot**. If correct, three of four lots are waterfront and the "cheapest waterfront" framing changes. (2) **Its acreage.** The card shows 1.0 ac but references a 1.27-ac LoopNet figure — a 27% swing. On the stated 1.0 ac this is **the most expensive land per acre in the portfolio**, not the mid-priced lot v1 implied.

1127 Saddle Horn Bend

Angleton, TX 77515 · Bar X Ranch Sec 2 SEC VERIFIED VIA STREET

\$82,500

\$42,308/acre · 1.95 ac

ZONE AE WATERFRONT LARGEST

Best for	Setback geometry — the extra acre is the real advantage for a 5BR + drainfield + reserve + well spacing.
Water body	Possibly Mill Bayou frontage (per neighbouring listing), not the "Bastrop Bayou West Trib" v1 assumed. CONFIRM
Watch	Waterfront slope: the lake edge is the low point; LOMA turns on lowest adjacent grade at the structure.

336 Wagon Wheel Trl W

Angleton, TX 77515 · Bar X Ranch, "Lot 167" **SECTION NOT IDENTIFIED**

\$45,000

\$45,000/acre · 1.00 ac

ZONE AE

WATERFRONT?

LOWEST PRICE

Best for

Lowest total outlay; cleared waterfront (less clearing cost).

Watch

1-acre **waterfront** is the tightest lot for TCEQ setbacks: well 100 ft from spray field, absorption 75 ft from normal pool. Test the footprint before buying.

Dues

v1's "\$250/yr" understates likely POA cost (~\$525/yr incl. vacant-lot mowing).

CONFIRM VIA RESALE CERT

Lot 29 Broken Arrow Trl

Angleton, TX 77515 · Bar X Ranch Sec 16

\$49,000

~\$49,000/acre · ~1.0 ac est.

ZONE AE

CUL-DE-SAC

INTERIOR

Best for

Privacy / low traffic; interior lot avoids the waterfront setback squeeze.

Watch

Acreage is estimated, not stated — confirm from plat. Sec 16 deed restrictions may differ from Sec 2.

750 Wagon Wheel Trl

Angleton, TX 77515 · Bar X Ranch **SECTION NOT IDENTIFIED**

\$58,000

\$58,000/acre · 1.0 ac (1.27?)

ZONE AE

WATERFRONT?

PRICIEST / ACRE

Status

Unresolved. Frontage (waterfront vs interior) and acreage (1.0 vs 1.27) both conflict between v1 and the listing of record. Do not rank until the plat settles both.

On stated size

Most expensive land per acre in the portfolio, by ~18% over the next dearest.

4 · Flood: what we actually know, and what we don't

The listing claim of "no flood risk" is false — all four lots are in a mapped **Special Flood Hazard Area (Zone AE)** because the Angleton Levee is not FEMA-accredited, regardless of natural ground height. That much is solid. The rest of v1's flood analysis rested on one optimistic assumption that was never justified.

The estimated BFE drives everything downstream — and it was picked from the bottom of a range.

IF SITE BFE IS...	FINISHED FLOOR REQ. (BFE+2 FT)	VS NATURAL GROUND 28-30 FT	CONSEQUENCE
24.0 ft V1'S FIGURE	26.0 ft	2-4 ft below grade	Met at grade. No fill for BFE. LOMA plausible.
25.0 ft (midpoint)	27.0 ft	1-3 ft below grade	Still met at grade.
26.4 ft (upstream cross-section)	28.4 ft	at/above grade on a 28-ft lot	Fill/stem wall needed; LOMA weaker.

THE GOOD NEWS V1 FAILED TO STATE PLAINLY

At 28-30 ft natural grade, the county's 26-ft minimum floor is **not the binding constraint** — build at grade and the finished floor lands near 28.5-31 ft on its own. v1's diagrams drew the finished floor *below* the ground, which is impossible; the reality is a comfortable margin, *if* the ~24 ft BFE holds per lot.

WHAT MUST BE CONFIRMED IN WRITING, PER LOT

- **Site-specific BFE** from Brazoria County Floodplain Administration — and which cross-section governs each lot (Bastrop Bayou West Trib vs Mill Bayou differ).
- **Lowest adjacent grade** from a topographic survey — not a single "28-30 ft" band applied to all four.
- **Pluvial (rainfall) ponding risk** — flat clay prairie floods from rain, not just rivers; the riverine BFE says nothing about it.
- **Levee accreditation trajectory** and any pending LOMR/preliminary FIRM.

Correction: the 24-in freeboard was set in 2005, not "raised after Harvey 2017." And fill + a LOMA are mutually exclusive — placing fill converts a (fee-free) LOMA into a LOMR-F, which carries a FEMA fee.

5 • Buildability — 5-bedroom + 2-car garage

REQUIREMENT	FIGURE	SOURCE / STATUS
Minimum living area	1,800 sq ft	Bar X ACC restrictions CONFIRM PER SECTION
Attached garage	22 × 20 = 440 sq ft	ACC U
Finished-floor elevation	□ BFE + 24 in	Brazoria County VERIFIED
Water	Private well	Register w/ Brazoria County Groundwater Conservation District V
Sewer	On-site septic (OSSF)	TCEQ 30 TAC 285 — see §6 V
Exterior materials	Brick / stone / stucco / Hardie	ACC; no mobile/trailer/metal siding U
Windstorm	WPI-8, engineer-certified	TDI — first-tier catastrophe county VERIFIED
Contractor	County IRC registration	Required before permit issues; no fee V

DESIGN-BASIS MISMATCH TO FIX

v1 sized the **septic for 5 bedrooms** while sizing the **house at the 1,800 sq ft minimum**. Those aren't the same house — 5 bedrooms plus living space is realistically 2,400–2,800 sq ft. The plan that drives the septic must also drive the square footage, the permit fee, and the pad. All figures here assume a ~2,400–2,800 sq ft 5BR.

6 • Septic (OSSF) — corrected against 30 TAC §285.91

This is where v1 was most wrong. The tank size it landed on (1,250 gal) happens to be right, but the drainfield was undersized 3–6×, the loading rate was off the regulatory table entirely, and the likely system type and its cost were absent.

Wastewater flow (Q), 5 BR under 4,500 sq ft — 30 TAC §285.91 Table III

BASIS	Q (GPD)	□ TANK (§285.91(2))
No water-saving devices (default)	450	Both fall in the 351–500 band □ 1,250 gal tank V
With water-saving devices	360	

Absorptive area = Q ÷ Ra (at Q = 450). Ra caps at 0.50 for the *most* permeable soil — v1's "0.6 gpd/sf" is off the table.

SOIL CLASS	RA (GAL/SF/DAY)	REQUIRED ABSORPTIVE AREA	LIKELY HERE?
Ia	>0.50	~900 sq ft	
Ib	0.38	~1,184 sq ft	
II	0.25	~1,800 sq ft	
III	0.20	~2,250 sq ft	likely (coastal clay)
IV	0.10	~4,500 sq ft	likely (coastal clay)

LIKELY SYSTEM: AEROBIC, NOT CONVENTIONAL — AND IT'S THE BIGGEST MISSING COST

Brazoria's coastal-prairie clay is Class III–IV. Class IV generally **cannot use a conventional drainfield**, so the permitted system is probably an **aerobic treatment unit (600-gal min) + spray/drip field**, requiring **~2,250–4,500 sq ft** plus 100% reserve, and a **TCEQ-mandated maintenance contract (~\$300–600/yr, forever)**. Installed cost **\$15k–\$25k**. v1 budgeted only the permit and soil test — the **system itself was missing entirely**.

TCEQ minimum separation distances (Table X) — these govern layout on 1-acre waterfront lots

FROM	TO	MIN.
Private well / cistern	Soil absorption / spray field	100 ft
Private well / cistern	Tank	50 ft
Lake / pond (normal pool)	Soil absorption / unlined ET	75 ft
Lake / pond (normal pool)	Surface (spray) application	50 ft

7 • Cost to build — corrected

v1 put pre-construction "soft costs" at ~\$11k–\$17k and called fill "minimal." Rebuilt from the county's actual fee schedule plus the omitted line items, one lot:

Pre-construction, one lot, 5BR. "In v1?" flags what the earlier document missed or mis-stated.

ITEM	LOW	HIGH	IN V1?
County development/building permit (flood zone: \$75 + \$0.04/sf)	\$165	\$200	overstated 7–11×
Fill & grading permit	\$0	\$80	missing
Contractor IRC registration	\$0	\$0	missing
OSSF site/soil evaluation	\$350	\$600	□
OSSF permit to construct	\$300	\$500	□
OSSF system installed (conventional □ aerobic+spray)	\$8,000	\$25,000	missing
Water well drilled + pump + pressure tank	\$10,000	\$20,000	□ (low)
Water treatment (coastal groundwater)	\$0	\$8,000	missing
Boundary + topographic survey	\$1,500	\$3,500	missing
Elevation certificate	\$500	\$900	□
LOMA/LOMR-F preparation (no FEMA fee for LOMA)	\$500	\$1,200	partly
Driveway culvert / county road access	\$1,500	\$5,000	missing
Electric service extension	\$0	\$25,000	missing
Propane tank + set (no natural gas)	\$1,000	\$3,000	missing
Clearing & grubbing	\$1,500	\$6,000	missing
Engineered pad / fill	\$0	\$8,000	partly
POA ACC review + transfer/resale cert	\$500	\$750	partly
Pre-construction subtotal	~\$26,000	~\$108,000	v1: \$11–17k

Central planning case **\$45k–\$65k**. The two wildcards that decide where you land: **soil class** (septic type) and **distance to power**.

All-in, one lot built

COMPONENT	LOW	HIGH
Land (one lot)	\$45,000	\$82,500
Pre-construction (above)	\$26,000	\$108,000
House, 2,400–2,800 sq ft @ \$175–\$250/sf EST.	\$420,000	\$700,000
Total, one lot built	~\$490,000	~\$890,000

8 • Annual carrying cost — the number v1 omitted

Holding four vacant lots. Tax rates: Brazoria County TY2025 Truth-in-Taxation. VERIFIED

ITEM	BASIS	PER YEAR
Property tax	~1.45–1.55% of \$234,500 (County 0.3048 + Columbia-Brazoria ISD 0.9530 + hospital/drainage/ESD, per \$100; no homestead/ag)	\$2,950–\$3,650
POA dues	4 × ~\$400/lot	~\$1,600
Vacant-lot mowing	4 × ~\$125/lot	~\$500
Total, 4 vacant lots		~\$5,050–\$5,750

□ a 2.2–2.5% annual drag on the \$234,500 land basis, before any build. Over a 3-year hold, ~\$15k–\$17k. POA/mowing figures from listing data — CONFIRM VIA RESALE CERTIFICATE .

9 • Insurance: flood *and* windstorm

v1 showed only a flood range (\$600–\$1,800/yr) and omitted windstorm — which, on the coast, is typically the larger line.

COVERAGE	NOTE	EST. ANNUAL
Flood (NFIP / private)	Risk Rating 2.0 prices on first-floor height + distance to water □ waterfront lots cost more. NFIP building cap \$250k; excess flood needed above.	\$1,500–\$4,000
Windstorm (TWIA)	First-tier catastrophe county; WPI-8 engineer cert required. State average residential premium ~\$2,541 VERIFIED	\$2,500–\$4,000
Homeowners (ex-wind, ex-flood)	Fire, liability, contents	\$1,000–\$1,500
Total once built EST.		~\$5,000–\$9,500

A LOMA (if granted) lifts the federal *mandatory-purchase* requirement on the flood line but does not end the exposure, and a lender may still require coverage. Windstorm is unaffected by any LOMA.

10 • Fishing & amenities — corrected

Bar X Ranch offers **two stocked lakes with boat ramp and pier**, plus (per listings) two swimming pools, two clubhouses, tennis and basketball courts, two playgrounds and pavilions — a richer amenity base than v1 described, and the reason dues are higher than v1 assumed.

CORRECTING V1'S "10/DAY • NO LICENSE ON PRIVATE"

- **These two claims can't both be regulatory.** Texas requires no licence on waters *wholly enclosed within private property* — and where that holds, **no state bag/size limits apply either**. So "10/day" can only be a **POA house rule**, not state law. **TPWD VERIFIED**
- **The private-water status is itself an open question.** The exemption requires the water not be subject to overflow from public water — but these lots sit in a mapped 1%-annual-chance floodplain in the Bastrop Bayou watershed. The flood finding undercuts the fishing premise.
- Statewide baseline (if public water): blue/channel catfish ~25/day combined; largemouth bass 5. **Black drum** (v1's on-site species) is brackish/saltwater — a bad data pull. Beach is ~30 min, not 20.

11 • What changed from v1 (top corrections)

#	V1 SAID	CORRECTED
1	Drainfield ~600-800 sf @ 0.6 gpd/sf	0.6 exceeds every TCEQ soil class; 2,250-4,500 sf on likely clay
2	Septic = permit cost only	Aerobic system likely; \$15k-\$25k installed + maintenance contract
3	Building permit \$1,200-\$1,800 + separate floodplain permit	One combined permit, ~\$165 total
4	Soft costs ~\$11k-\$17k	~\$26k-\$108k; central \$45k-\$65k
5	(no construction cost)	House \$420k-\$700k; all-in one lot \$490k-\$890k
6	(no windstorm)	TWIA avg ~\$2,541/yr; WPI-8 engineer cert required
7	(no property tax / carry)	~\$5,050-\$5,750/yr on four vacant lots
8	Harvey 2017 raised freeboard to 2 ft	Set May 2005, 12 years earlier
9	750 Wagon Wheel = interior lot	Listing of record says waterfront — resolve by plat
10	LOMA ~\$500-\$900 fee; also place fill	No FEMA fee for LOMA; fill forecloses LOMA (≠ LOMR-F)
11	"Zoning 0140," single-family zoning	No county zoning; 0140 is a BCAD land-use code; deed restrictions govern
12	POA \$250/yr (one lot only)	~\$525/yr per vacant lot; ~\$2,100/yr for four

Full 25-item list with severity and sourcing in docs/AUDIT.md.

12 • Due-diligence sequence

1. **Decide the premise** — one lot or four. Nothing else sizes until this is answered.
2. **Pull parcel IDs** for all four from BCAD (account #, legal description, acreage of record, plat). v1 contained none.
3. **Confirm jurisdiction** — unincorporated county vs Angleton city limits, per parcel.
4. **Request written BFE per lot** from Brazoria County Floodplain & 911 Administration, 451 N Velasco Ste 210, Angleton TX 77515 · 979-864-1295 (also 281-756-1295). Ask which stream governs each lot.
5. **Resolve 750 Wagon Wheel's frontage & acreage** from the plat.

6. **Order a soil/site evaluation** on the shortlisted lot — it decides septic type, the largest cost swing.
7. **Order boundary + topo survey**; test septic/well/lake setbacks against a real 5BR footprint.
8. **Get 3 quotes each** for well, septic, and electric service extension.
9. **Get TWIA windstorm + RR2.0 flood quotes** on the actual structure; price excess flood above \$250k.
10. **Pull recorded restrictions** for each lot's specific section + a POA resale certificate.
11. **Confirm Angleton Levee accreditation status** and check for pending LOMR / preliminary FIRM.
12. **Re-run the comparison** and issue a ranked recommendation.

Disclaimer. This is an independent desktop review of an existing document, prepared from published regulations and public records. It is **not** a survey, engineering opinion, flood determination, insurance advice, legal advice, or an appraisal, and it is not a substitute for the licensed professionals and the written county determination named in §12. Figures marked **ESTIMATE** are planning ranges; figures marked **UNVERIFIED** derive from third-party listing copy or the superseded v1 and must be independently confirmed before any purchase decision.

Bar X Ranch — 4-Lot Feasibility Portfolio · v2.0 rebuild · prepared 10 Sep 2026 · sources: docs/SOURCES.md · audit: docs/AUDIT.md